

**ROAD FLIP**  
Ricky Davis' clutch  
free throws left  
Cavs past Raptors,  
end 14-game skid  
away from home.  
D7



# Sports

The Chronicle-Telegram Saturday, January 4, 2003 D1

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## Despite playoffs, '94 was no fan favorite

**Steve King**  
The Chronicle-Telegram

**BEREA** — With their date  
Sunday against the Pitts-  
burgh Steelers at Heinz  
Field, the Browns are in the  
playoffs for the first time  
since 1964.

But, strange as it might  
sound, that  
was not the  
last enjoy-  
able season  
for the team.  
No, you'd  
probably have  
to go back to the  
late 1980s,  
when the  
Bernie  
Kosar-led  
teams were  
going to the  
postseason  
five straight  
times and  
making it to  
the AFC Championship game  
on three occasions.

In comparison, 1994 didn't  
measure up in any way,  
shape or form even though  
the Browns finished 11-5 and  
nearly grabbed the Central  
title before finally relenting  
to Pittsburgh (12-4). And even  
though it was the Browns'  
first appearance in the play-  
offs in five years, in many  
respects 1994 was a bitter,  
miserable season.

As such, it was a strange,  
bizarre season — maybe like  
no other in Browns history  
except for the one that fol-  
lowed and signaled the end of  
the original Browns' stay in  
Cleveland.

The reason wasn't hard to  
figure out, really. In fact, it  
was simple, as anyone who  
was around then will attest:  
Doug Dieken was around  
then. He has been around the  
Browns as a player or radio  
analyst for the last 32 years.  
If you want a history of the  
team for the last 31 years,  
talk to the former left tackle.

"The people were still  
ticked off at (Bill) Belichick  
for getting rid of Kosar the  
year before," Dieken said.

"A lot of those guys from  
the '80s teams — the guys the  
fans really liked — were gone  
by that time. They had 10  
new starters from the previous  
year," Clay Matthews and  
See **BROWNS, D6**



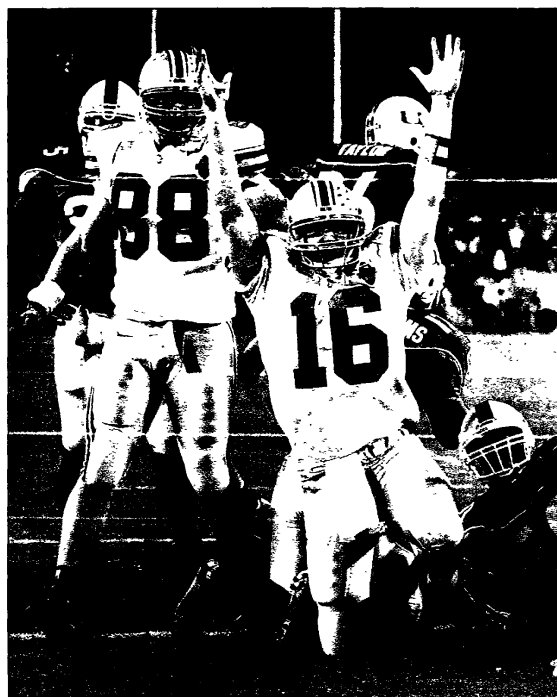
### INSIDE

**COULDA, SHOULD:**  
Linebacker  
Andre Davis  
would have  
been the hero  
had the  
Browns held  
on to beat the  
Steelers in  
their first  
meeting this  
season. D6

OHIO STATE 31 MIAMI 24

# A Buckeye bombshell

**CLUTCH KRENZEL:**  
Ohio State  
quarterback  
Craig  
Krenzel (16)  
celebrates  
his TD  
against  
Miami to tie  
the game  
and send it  
into a second  
overtime  
Friday in the  
Fiesta Bowl  
in Tempe,  
Ariz. Ohio  
State's Ben  
Hartscock  
(88) is at left.



## OSU shocks Miami in 2OT, earns first national title in 34 years

**Chris Assenheimer**  
The Chronicle-Telegram

**TEMPE, Ariz.** — An Ohio  
State team that produced  
countless miraculous victories  
during the regular season had  
one left Friday night at Sun  
Devil Stadium.

The Buckeyes, who were  
given little chance of beating a  
Miami team that entered the  
Fiesta Bowl showdown as an  
overwhelming favorite, com-  
pleted a shocking upset of the  
top-ranked Hurricanes, win-  
ning 31-24 in two overtimes.

With the eyes of the world  
upon them, the Buckeyes, who  
came from behind to win nine  
times in the regular season  
conjured up one final magic act  
on the largest of stages.

"We are so proud of these  
young men," said Ohio State  
coach Jim Tressel after being  
presented with the national  
championship trophy. "We've  
always had the best damn band  
in the land. Now we have the  
best damn team in the land."

Maurice Clarett's 5-yard  
touchdown run in the second  
extra period wound up being  
the game-winning score after  
Ohio State stopped Miami on  
fourth down from the one,  
when linebacker Cle Grant  
pressed Hurricanes quarter-  
back Ken Dorsey into a wild  
throw that landed incomplete  
at the goal line.

The Buckeyes were forced to  
sweat out the victory when  
Miami sent the game into over-  
time on a 40-yard field goal  
from Todd Seivers. Seivers  
kicked slipped just inside the  
right upright to tie the game  
as time expired.

OSU offered up more perspi-  
ration in the first overtime  
when Miami scored on an 8-  
yard pass to Kellen Winslow,  
forcing the Buckeyes to match  
the touchdown.

The Buckeyes converted a  
fourth-and-14 play with a 17-  
yard reception from Michael  
Jenkins, but appeared to lose  
the game when Chris Gamble  
couldn't come up with a pass  
on fourth-and-3.

But a late interference flag on  
the play gave OSU new life and  
See **OSU, D2**



### INSIDE

**DOSS IS BOSS:**  
Ohio State strong  
safety Michael  
Doss made the  
right decision,  
returning for senior  
season.  
**BY THE RULES:**  
Game's crucial call goes  
Buckeyes' way,  
keeping dream of  
national title alive.  
Page D3

## Blue-collar Buckeyes do the job

**TEMPE, Ariz.** — Flashbulbs pop-  
ping, tears falling, fireworks filling  
the sky.  
And yes, history in the making.  
Ohio State 31, Miami 24.  
Double overtime.  
National champions, the hard way.  
The Buckeye way.  
Can you believe it?

This wasn't just OSU's first national title in 34 years,  
it was a game for the ages featuring the best college  
football has to offer on the sport's biggest stage, the  
Fiesta Bowl.

It was 14 games and four hours in the making. It  
ended with Buckeye Cle Grant tugging Ken Dorsey



**Terry  
Pluto**

down, as the Miami quarterback  
threw up a lob that was batted down  
at the goal line.

Or as Coach Jim Tressel said, "This  
is what a national championship  
game should look like, two great  
heavyweights slug it out."

The Buckeyes won this game despite  
star Maurice Clarett having a very  
human day, only 47 yards on the ground. They won  
despite a star-studded, NFL-bound roster from Miami.  
They won not so much because they were the better  
team, they just played better.

See **PLUTO, D2**

**KEEP ON  
PUSHING:**  
Olmsted  
Falls guard  
Tim Curran  
tries to drive  
past North  
Olmsted's  
Jason  
Mahon  
during  
Friday's  
battle for  
first place in  
the SWC.  
Curran  
scored  
17 points  
as Falls  
won easily,  
75-45.



**TOM MAHL / CHRONICLE**

## Non-attack 'Dogs just as scary

**Rahula Strohl**  
The Chronicle-Telegram

**OLMSTED FALLS** — North Olm-  
sted got Olmsted Falls out of its  
game early on Friday night.  
But then the Bulldogs dropped  
back and beat the Eagles at their  
own game.

North Olmsted broke Falls' full-  
court press in the first quarter, but  
Falls pulled back to a half-court  
game and cruised to a 75-45 victory  
in a battle of Southwestern Confer-  
ence unbeatens.

The win kept the Bulldogs unde-  
feated at 8-0 overall and 4-0 in the  
league. North Olmsted fell to 6-2  
and 3-1.

"I thought we did a good job with

## Olmsted Falls backs off press, blows out Eagles

the press," said Eagles coach Tim  
Schmotzer. "When they moved to  
half-court we thought that played  
into our hands."

But the hall seemed to find Falls'  
hands instead. The Bulldogs' half-  
court game frustrated North Olm-  
sted into five turnovers in the second  
quarter and Falls outscored the  
Eagles 17-4 for the period.

After 21 points in the first quar-  
ter, North Olmsted (6-2, 3-1) man-  
aged only 24 the last three quarters.

North Olmsted was 10-for-11 from  
the floor the first six minutes of the  
game and 6-for-25 the rest of the  
game.

"They were well-prepared for the  
press, when that's your method for  
five to six years, teams get well-pre-  
pared," Dunahue said. "They gave  
themselves some nice looks."

"When we pulled the press that  
allowed us to do a better job match-  
ing up. Matchups are something  
you can't dictate at the end of the  
press, that's the nature of it."

Falls Juniors Jamar Scates and  
Steve Gansey carried the Bulldogs  
during the comeback.  
Gansey scored Falls' first 11

See **FALLS, D4**



### INSIDE

**COMET TALE:**  
Amherst lets an  
18-point lead  
disappear, but still  
pulls out a win over  
Westlake in CIT.  
**FALLS:**  
North  
Fallsville gets 20  
points from Adam  
Montgomery, beats  
Midpark to go to 7-2.  
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